PLANT PROTECTION ASSOCIATION OF INDIA (PPAI)

Indian Journal of Plant Protection (IJPP) — Editorial Workflow

Executive Operational Specification: Submission → Screening → Peer Review → Decision Release

Target Pipeline: Author to Chief Editor Direct Flow	**Document Type:** System Architecture Specification	**Associate Editor:** Bypassed (Direct to Chief Editor)

Operational Rule: The Associate Editor tier is currently inactive. All screening, reviewer assignment, credentials provisioning, and moderation release actions are executed directly within the Chief Editor Console (/portal/admin/).

1 Author Manuscript Submission & Payment Upload

Actor: Author

The author submits the manuscript online through the portal form with full bibliographic metadata and mandatory payment details.

Manuscript Data:

- Unique Tracking ID (e.g. `IJPP-2026-XXXX`)
- Title, Structured Abstract & 5–8 Keywords
- Subject Discipline (Entomology, Pathology, etc.)
- Manuscript DOCX/PDF & Supplementary Data

Payment Information:

- Payment Transaction ID (UPI / Bank UTR)
- Payment Screenshot (Attached image proof)
- Submission Declaration & Conflict of Interest

Automated Trigger 1 → Email to Author (Acknowledgment): Immediate delivery of Tracking ID, Paper Title, Abstract, Payment Transaction ID, and confirmation that payment screenshot proof was logged.

Automated Trigger 2 → Email to Chief Editor: Full submission alert with Tracking ID, author affiliation, payment transaction ID, payment screenshot link, and the **attached manuscript file** for direct screening.

2 Chief Editor Console — Author-Centric Card View (/portal/admin/)

Screen: Chief Editor Console

Submissions are populated into the Chief Editor Console structured **per Author** rather than detached per-manuscript cards. All submissions and payment proofs by a given author are organized within their dedicated Author Card.

Author-Centric Card Display Metrics (Card Set Per Author):

- **Author Identity & Profile:**
  Corresponding Author Name, Registered Email, Institutional Affiliation, and Registration Date.
- **Grouped Author Manuscripts:**
  All papers lodged by this author listed with Tracking ID, Full Title, Submission Date & Discipline.
- **Payment Verification per Paper:**
  Direct display of Transaction ID (Bank/UPI) and one-click preview of Payment Screenshot proof.
- **Chief Editor Quick Actions:**
  Download Full Manuscript, View Abstract, and Initiate Reviewer Assignment per submission.

3 Chief Editor Reviewer Assignment & Window Time

Actor: Chief Editor

After verifying payment and technical scope from the author's card, the Chief Editor assigns a specialized peer reviewer and defines an explicit evaluation window (e.g. 14 days).

Automated Trigger 3 → Reviewer Invitation Email (via Brevo): Sent immediately to reviewer containing paper title, abstract, and acceptance deadline window with interactive "Accept / Decline Review" buttons.

Automated Timer & Follow-up Reminder: If the reviewer has not acknowledged within the specified window time, an automated reminder email is dispatched to ensure timely turnaround.

4 Reviewer & Associate Editor Credentials Provisioning

Actors: Chief Editor, Reviewer & Associate Editor

The Chief Editor creates and provisions portal login credentials directly inside the Chief Editor Console (`/portal/admin/`) for **both Reviewers and Associate Editors**.

Automated Trigger 4 → Credentials Email (via Brevo): Chief Editor registers user with designated role (*Associate Editor* or *Reviewer*) → system dispatches Login Email, Initial Password, and Portal URL (`/login/`).

Role-Based Login Flow:

Newly provisioned user visits `/login/`, selects their designated role chip (**Reviewer** or **Associate Editor**) under the username & password fields, signs in, and lands directly on their dedicated dashboard (`/portal/reviewer/` or `/portal/editor/`).

5 Reviewer Evaluation Workspace (/portal/reviewer/evaluate/)

Screen: Reviewer Workspace

Reviewer clicks the manuscript card under "Your Assignments" to enter the peer-review workspace and submit comprehensive feedback.

1. Standardized Rubric & Decision:

- Originality, Technical Quality, Clarity, Significance (Scores 1 to 5)
- Overall Recommendation: *Accept / Minor Revision / Major Revision / Reject*

2. Dual Feedback Channels:

- **Comments for Author:** Blinded constructive feedback (held until editor approval).
- **Confidential Remarks:** Visible *strictly* to Chief Editor only.

6 Chief Editor Review Moderation & Author Release

Final Decision & Release

Upon submission by the reviewer, the evaluation flows immediately to the Chief Editor for quality control and final release.

Automated Trigger 5 → Alert to Chief Editor: Notifies Chief Editor that the review for [Tracking ID] is completed and ready for inspection.

Chief Editor Approval in Application:

- Chief Editor reviews scores, author comments, and confidential remarks.
- Chief Editor clicks **Approve & Release Comments to Author** and issues the formal editorial decision.

Automated Trigger 6 → Formal Decision Email to Author: Author receives official editorial letter with moderated review comments. Author portal dashboard updates status simultaneously.

Summary Matrix of Workflow Stages & Triggered Communications

Stage	Actor & Screen	Actions & Data Transferred	Triggered Emails
1. Submission	Author (Submission Form)	Uploads manuscript files, abstract, keywords, **Payment Txn ID** & **Payment Screenshot**.	• **To Author:** Acknowledgment with all data. • **To Chief Editor:** Alert with paper + payment proof.
2. Screening	Chief Editor (`/portal/admin/`)	Reviews **Author Cards** (card per author) grouping submitted papers, submission dates, Author profile, Payment Txn ID & Payment Screenshot.	*Internal portal verification*
3. Assignment	Chief Editor (`/portal/admin/`)	Assigns Reviewer and sets **Evaluation Deadline Window**.	• **To Reviewer (via Brevo):** Invitation with paper details & time window. • **Auto-Reminder:** Sent if no response.
4. Credentials	Chief Editor (`/portal/admin/`)	Chief Editor creates credentials for **both Reviewer and Associate Editor**. Users log in at `/login/`.	• **To User (via Brevo):** Login Username, Password & Portal URL.
5. Evaluation	Reviewer (`/portal/reviewer/evaluate/`)	Submits rubric scores, recommendation, **Author Comments**, and **Confidential Editor Remarks**.	Review marked complete; author comments locked pending Chief Editor approval.
6. Release	Chief Editor (`/portal/admin/`)	Inspects confidential notes & scores. Approves comments and issues formal decision (Accept / Revision / Reject).	• **To Chief Editor:** Review complete notice. • **To Author:** Final decision letter with peer review comments.